

Muncie Sanitary District Meeting February 19th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aIYJrhfA9NQ
Publication Date	2025-02-20T05:09:52Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Board of Sanitary Commissioners: Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: February 19, 2025

Governing Body: Board of Sanitary Commissioners

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** [00:00:25](#) Statutory Public Hearing on Resolution 2025-2, to amend and fix the schedule of sewer rates and charges to add a nonprofit billing line.
- **Summary of Discussion:** The presiding officer opened the public hearing and called for public comment regarding the proposed creation of a separate nonprofit billing tier (situated between commercial and residential billing, featuring slightly higher usage rates and a lower fixed rate). No members of the public spoke during the hearing. A motion was made, seconded, and passed unanimously by voice vote to close the public hearing.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:01:50](#) The regular meeting of the Board of Sanitary Commissioners was called to order by the presiding officer for February 19, 2025,

immediately following the close of the public hearing.

- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** All sanitary commissioners (including Commissioners Clark, Overton, Selvie, and Smith).
 - **Excused Absences:** None.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:02:22 The board reviewed and approved the minutes from the February 5, 2025, meeting by voice vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:02:55 **Register of Claims:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Total claims presented amounted to \$621,718.93. Commissioner Clark highlighted key line items, including disposal services through East Central Recycling (\$177,436), a \$115,000 partnership with Downtown Development for cleanup and event assistance, and a \$44,000 flow monitoring expense for the northern end of town in coordination with the Delaware Regional District.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- 00:04:37 **District Administrator Update:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Levy tie-back construction is making good progress, with positive feedback from the Army Corps, keeping spring construction on schedule.
 - Sewer bills have been updated to explicitly display user classes (residential, commercial, institutional, governmental) and itemized rates following previous feedback from local business owners and board members. A more formal written appeal process has been instituted for billing/classification disputes.
 - Following interviews of four separate bond council firms for anticipated future bans and bonds, the district selected **Ice Miller**.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information-only update; no board vote required.
- 00:08:06 **Department Head Update (Sanitation & Code Enforcement):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason Denhani, Sanitation Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**

- Provided a 2024 departmental overview, highlighting recycling program growth, countywide school rollofs, electronic waste curbside pickup (noting that electronic processing costs have doubled), household hazardous waste, tire recycling, and sharps disposal.
 - Noted that East Central Recycling froze tipping fees for two years, but an annual CPI increase (not to exceed 8%) takes effect July 6.
 - Code enforcement has been highly active, assisting the building commissioner and MPD with abandoned camp cleanups and point-in-time homeless counts. Lease-toter fees increase from \$5 to \$10 a month starting March 1.
 - Two new automated trucks are expected in June 2025 (significantly delayed from their April 2023 order date).
 - Compressed Natural Gas (CNG) station updates: RNG credits average \$5,000 to \$6,000 monthly, and the BP fuel contract expires at the end of June 2025.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information-only update; no board vote required.
- **00:24:14 Resolution 2025-2: Amending and Fixing the Schedule of Sewer Rates and Charges (Nonprofit Billing Line):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tim / Board Leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brought forward from old business following previous input from the faith community. The resolution establishes a dedicated nonprofit billing category positioned between commercial and residential tiers, featuring a lower fixed rate and slightly adjusted usage rates.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this session (prior public hearing held at [00:00:25](#)).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No general public comments were brought forward during the open public comment period [00:02:01](#).*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The board noted an upcoming cost-savings business meeting scheduled with MSD leadership in March to review process improvements and cost-control initiatives.
 - Commissioner Smith commended the legal team at Defer-Rand (specifically Joe and his team) for their ongoing service and support.
- **Adjournment:** [00:28:19](#) A motion to adjourn was made and seconded, passing by voice vote.

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